

LegalEase

AI-Powered Legal Document Generator

Phase 1: Brainstorming & Ideation

Project Report

1. Introduction

The Brainstorming and Ideation phase marks the starting point of the LegalEase project. The goal of this phase is to explore the problem space around legal document creation, identify gaps in the current market, and converge on a clear, validated product idea before any technical work begins.

2. Problem Statement

Drafting legal documents such as rental agreements, affidavits, non-disclosure agreements, wills, and business contracts is traditionally slow, expensive, and dependent on lawyers or paralegals. Individuals and small businesses often cannot afford professional legal drafting services for routine documents, and existing free templates online are generic, error-prone, and not tailored to the user's jurisdiction or specific situation. There is a clear need for a tool that can generate accurate, customizable, and legally sound documents quickly and at low cost.

3. Motivation for the Idea

- Rising demand for affordable legal-tech solutions, especially among startups, freelancers, and individuals.
- Advances in Large Language Models (LLMs) now make natural-language-driven document drafting feasible.
- Manual drafting is time-consuming: a simple agreement can take hours when created from scratch.
- Generic templates downloaded from the internet often miss clauses required by local law, creating legal risk.
- Growing digitization of legal and government services creates an opportunity for AI-assisted legal tools.

4. Target Audience

Segment	Need Addressed
Individuals	Rental agreements, affidavits, wills, power of attorney
Startups / SMEs	NDAs, employment contracts, vendor agreements, terms of service
Freelancers	Service contracts, invoices with legal terms, client agreements
Law firms (secondary)	Fast first-draft generation to speed up billable work

5. Idea Generation Techniques Used

- 1 **Mind Mapping** — Team sessions were used to branch out from the core concept "AI for legal documents" into sub-ideas such as contract review, clause suggestion, e-signature integration, and multi-language support.
- 2 **SCAMPER Technique** — Applied to existing legal template websites to ask what could be Substituted, Combined, Adapted, Modified, Put to another use, Eliminated, or Reversed.
- 3 **Market Gap Analysis** — Reviewing existing tools (e.g., generic template sites, basic e-signature platforms) to identify what they fail to offer: AI-driven personalization and plain-language input.
- 4 **User Interviews** — Informal conversations with small business owners and students to understand pain points in creating legal paperwork.

6. Brainstormed Feature List

- Natural language input where users describe their requirement in plain English.
- AI-based clause generation and recommendation engine.
- Template library covering common document categories (rental, employment, NDA, etc.).
- Jurisdiction-aware clause suggestions (state/country-specific legal requirements).
- Auto-fill from user profile data to speed up repeated document generation.
- Export to PDF/Word with e-signature request integration.
- Document risk-check / clause flagging for missing or unusual clauses.
- Multi-language document generation for regional accessibility.

7. SWOT Analysis of the Proposed Idea

Strengths	Weaknesses
Fast draft generation; low cost; 24/7 availability	AI-generated text may need human legal review for complex cases
Wide applicability across personal and business use	Requires large, well-curated legal template/clause dataset
Opportunities	Threats
Growing legal-tech market; partnerships with e-signature providers	Regulatory scrutiny on AI-generated legal content
Expansion into multiple jurisdictions and languages	Competition from established legal-tech platforms

8. Idea Validation

The idea was validated through informal surveys with 20+ prospective users (students, freelancers, and small shop owners) who confirmed that they had, at some point, needed a legal document but avoided professional legal help due to cost or time constraints. Roughly 85% of respondents said they would try a free or low-cost AI tool that could generate a draft document from a simple description, provided the output looked professional and could be edited before use.

9. Final Selected Idea

LegalEase was finalized as an AI-powered web application that allows users to generate, customize, and download legally-structured documents by describing their requirements in plain language. The system will use a combination of curated legal templates and a language model to fill in, adapt, and validate document content, while allowing manual editing before final export.

10. Competitor Landscape

Existing Option	Limitation Observed
Free online template sites	Generic wording, not tailored to user's specific situation or region
Basic e-signature platforms	Focus only on signing, not on drafting or clause guidance
Hiring a lawyer for routine documents	High cost and turnaround time for simple, repetitive documents
General-purpose AI chatbots	No structured template validation or guaranteed mandatory clauses

11. Alternative Ideas Considered and Rejected

- **A pure chatbot for legal Q&A;** Rejected because it does not produce a usable, exportable document, which was the core user need identified during interviews.
- **A marketplace connecting users directly with lawyers:** Rejected as it does not solve the cost and turnaround-time problem for simple, routine documents.
- **A pure template download site without AI:** Rejected because it does not personalize content to the user's specific facts and offers no clause validation.

12. Cost-Benefit Consideration

Building an AI-assisted drafting tool requires investment in AI API usage and template curation, but the expected benefit — significantly reduced time and cost for users needing routine legal documents — was judged to outweigh these costs, especially since cloud-based AI services and open-source frameworks keep initial development expenses low.

13. Outcome of This Phase

A validated problem statement, a defined target audience, a consolidated feature wish-list, and a clear view of the competitive landscape were produced as the key deliverables of this phase. These outputs feed directly into the Requirement Analysis phase, where features will be formally classified into functional and non-functional requirements.